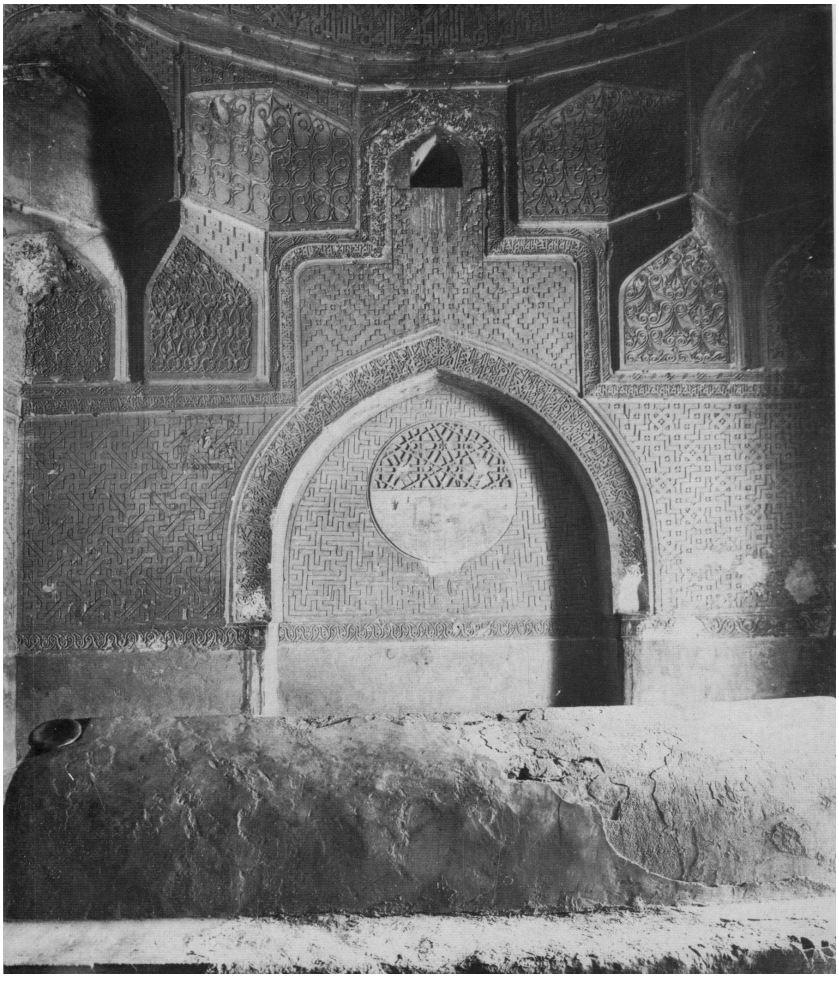


Figure I.17 *Tomb of Salar Khalil, Juzjan Province, interior. From Sourdel-Thomine 1971: fig. XV.*

and interiors of the Bust structure (Figures I.18 and I.19) carried decorations primarily consisting of baked bricks placed in horizontal or vertical clusters, and terracotta plugs deployed in a remarkable variety of ornament, ranging from textured surfaces; geometric patterns, including a plethora of medallions; to the angular Kufic frieze running along the exterior of the dome's octagonal base. Meanwhile, the Juzjan tomb (Figures I.16 and I.17) seemed to act as the stage for an elaborate epigraphic program of variations on the Kufic script against equally diverse backgrounds. Both the differences and commonalities in these tomb structures – located at two ends of the early Shansabanis' core imperial regions in Afghanistan – are worthy of note, as together they personify two of the manifold iterations within a region's architectural culture.